

IG 5 VISION

Our goals for this year is less about *our* vision for the IG, but more about God's vision for each member. Throughout the year, we hope that everyone will be able to explore how God's vision for us is the most important vision in our lives, and how that relates to our personal faith, as well as our responsibilities within the communities we have been blessed with.

Seeing Each Other's Godly Worth

Firstly, we need to trust that not only has God already blessed us with so many things to be grateful for (food, friends, education, the earth, etc.), WE were also created to be blessings to the earth. We are treasured by God, intentionally sent with a purpose. Jesus tells us this in **Matthew 10:30-31**:

²⁹ Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father's care.^[a] ³⁰ And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. ³¹ So don't be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.

It might feel weird to say that WE are blessings, but the Creator of the cosmos designed the universe so that He could have a personal relationship with you. You are of great value, intricately created such that He even knows the count of hairs on your head. In IG this year, let us remind each other of our Godly worth. Let us cultivate an environment of encouragement and support, lifting each other up to see the fruits we have been blessed with.

Practical Applications:

- Extending our time together as an IG beyond Friday nights - we want to create opportunities to get to know each other better consistently throughout the week. This might look like going to the gym together, weekly study sessions, or exploring Toronto together on weekends
- Setting aside time to have meaningful conversations about our weekly lives and struggles, praying for each other and growing together spiritually.

Everyone as Equals

In light of this, it is important that each member of the IG realizes that we are all equals in doing God's good work. As Paul tells us in 1 Corinthians 3:9:

⁹For we are co-workers in God's service; you are God's field, God's building.

Whether we are leaders or members of the IG, each and every member of the IG is equally important and each member was created by God to have different strengths to contribute. A plan made by only the IG leaders would not be nearly as good as one created by putting together the abilities of all the IG members.

Practical Applications:

- Having specified times where IG members can come and give their opinions and feedback on planning for the week. We would love to build an IG community together rather than just leaders!
- Ensuring that everyone shares burdens equally, leaders/upper years should not be delegating tasks to others so that they have less to do.

Light in this World

Additionally, not only are we treasured by God, he has planned for us to share this treasure with the rest of his creation... and maybe not just *share*, but to *illuminate*, as in **Matthew 5:14-16**:

¹⁴“You are the light of the world. A town built on a hill cannot be hidden. ¹⁵ Neither do people light a lamp and put it under a bowl. Instead they put it on its stand, and it gives light to everyone in the house. ¹⁶In the same way, let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven.

It might seem like a daunting task, to “illuminate the world.” We’ll probably have to devote many more years to it, possibly even our whole lives. But if IG this year can even just give us a glimpse into the reality that each of us can “give light to everyone in the house,” that’s a huge success. So let us create an IG where we become comfortable in sharing our light. Where vulnerability doesn’t feel like being exposed, but instead gives us confidence that we are the prism that lets God’s light reach others.

“Don't shine so others can see you. Shine so that through you, others can see Him.”

- C.S. Lewis

Practical Application:

- Creating an environment where members are able to feel vulnerable and comfortable sharing their stories while walking alongside others
- Including more time for prayer, and mini-testimony sharings
- Serve together as an IG - make an effort to bring up volunteering opportunities to the IG, grow closer by serving the community together
- Once we get to know each other’s strengths/passions, suggest ways they use those passions to serve in their churches, CCF and careers, create a servant-like mindset among our IG.